Interview

We're working on a software engineering project for a website that helps people decide whether video games are worth playing or buying. We're researching how gamers currently find and evaluate game reviews.

Please answer these questions based on your own experiences. There are no right or wrong answers. Examples are especially helpful, and short answers are fine.

Questions

1. Think about the last game you bought, downloaded, or seriously considered playing. How did you decide whether it was worth trying?

Mortal shell 2, best friend recommended based on its difficulty (I like difficult games), I looked up the trailer and saw a character design I really liked (Grogu). So I bought it and I am very satisfied with my purchase.

2. Where do you usually go to find information or reviews about games?

For example, do you use Steam reviews, YouTube, Reddit, gaming websites, friends, streamers, or something else?

Friends and YouTube, all it takes is for me to see something that catches my attention in a game and I'll consider buying it

3. What information matters most to you when deciding whether to play or buy a game?

For example, gameplay, price, performance, difficulty, multiplayer features, replayability, or whether the game receives updates.

Definitely difficulty

I'd say graphics (well polished any style, 2D, 3D, animated, hyper realistic, cgi).

Multiplayer features if it's a game I want to play with friends

4. Have you ever found that different reviewers or websites disagreed about a game? What did you do?

I mean all the time, to each his own opinion, some people love dififcult games like myself and others absolutely hate them. Some love guns others don't, some like parkour and others don't, some people like cinematic and others don't. People's opinions don't really matter too much to me because I don't know them and they don't know me, my friends know what I like so their recommendations are on par, where as some random guy could hate souls like games because of the difficulty and lack of direction (it's an open world) and then just hate on the game with it even bringing that up, so the opinions of the masses are irrelevant

5. What makes you trust a game review or rating? What makes you distrust it?

I trust it if it feels real, is personal, and detailed

The opposite of that is what makes me distrust it

6. Have you ever played a game that was very different from what its reviews led you to expect?

If so, what was different? What information would have helped you make a better decision?

Not that I can remember, I don't really look at reviews, I rank my own thoughts and attractions, as well as friends opinions too much to look at the pointless swarms of online comments where no one can agree or be allowed to be happy.

7. How much attention do you pay to numerical scores compared with written reviews or comments from other players?

Which do you find most useful, and why?

Once again I don't really take the ever changing and tenuous opinions of the community, review bombs happen all the time, and glaze trains happen as well, so I really just base it on my own thoughts and opinions of friends

8. What problems have you noticed with online game reviews or ratings?

For example, fake reviews, review bombing, outdated reviews after updates, or reviewers judging a game by standards that don't match your interests.

Well yeah I just spoke on glaze trains and review bombing, but yeah it’s a great idea to move away from what the mob think and just think for yourself with advice from friends that know you or have played the game. It’s like the fashion standard of society changed every 3 months, it’s so feeble and ever changing, not really worth dipping your toes into it.

9. Imagine a website that brings together game ratings and reviews from several different sources. What would make you want to use it? What would make you hesitate to trust it?

Not really, bringing the reviews all together isn’t a bad idea but considering I don’t trust the origin of the reviews (people) to address the criteria of how I like games to be. It’d be enticing in the fact that all the reviews are in one spot so I don’t have to sift around, just filter a button to see what different sources but I just rely on people I know and myself.

10. If you could change one thing about how people find, compare, or evaluate game reviews, what would you change?

Just be personal and actually explain the underlying reasons, if a game is difficult because you are bad, just say you don’t like harder difficulty games because of your skill level, if you don’t like the story line because it’s a dark horror like and you like sunshine and rainbows then just say it, but don’t dog on a game because it did something you don’t like and then you get angry and try to rip as many parts of it to hell with insults and poorly put to gather arguments.

11. Is there anything else about how you choose games or use reviews that you think our team should understand?

Not at the moment.